

doc-gender-binary

Affirms · Anthropology › Created Order · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

God created humanity male and female as a fixed binary rooted in creation; biological sex and gender identity are coherent and not subject to self-determined redefinition.

Rationale

The pan-canonical lexical pattern locks the male-female binary at the creation-design level. Gen 1:27 names the binary in three parallel clauses: vayyivra Elohim et-haadam betsalmo (H1254 bara, created) ... zakar (H2145, male, noun masc sg) uneqebah (H5347, female, noun fem sg) bara otam. Gen 5:2 restates the binary with the divine naming: zakar uneqebah beraam vayyivarekh otam vayyiqra et-shemam Adam, the binary is the content of the species-name. Gen 2:18-25 builds the ish (H376) / ishshah (H802) pair etymologically (ki me-ish luqachah-zot, because from man this was taken), and concludes vehayu lebasar (H1320) echad (H259), the marital union presupposes the binary distinction. Jesus appeals to both Genesis texts together in Matt 19:4-6 / Mark 10:6-9: ho ktisas (G2936) ap arches arsen (G730, male) kai thely (G2338, female) epoiesen autous, citing Gen 1:27, then citing Gen 2:24 (heneka toutou kataleipsei anthropos ton patera ... eis sarka mian, into one flesh). The binary is the foundation of the marriage union in Jesus' own reading. Paul in Rom 1:26-27 lexically welds the binary to the natural order: hai thelyai (G2338) auton meteliخان ten physiken chresin eis ten para physin (G3844 + G5449, against nature) ... homoios kai hoi arsenes (G730) aphenes ten physiken chresin tes thelyas. Para physin presupposes a physis (nature) that the male-female ordering instantiates. Matt 19:12 honestly surfaces eunouchoi (G2135) ek koilias metros, eunuchs from birth, recognizing intersex / congenital anomaly without dissolving the binary as the created norm. The concordance pattern: zakar H2145 occurs about 82 times, neqebah H5347 occurs 22 times always paired with zakar (Gen 1:27, 5:2, 6:19, 7:3, 7:9, 7:16 of the ark animals, Lev 3:1, 3:6, 4:28, 4:32, 5:6, 12:5, 12:7, 15:33, 27:4-7 valuation, Num 5:3, 31:15, Deut 4:16, Jer 31:22), arsen G730 and thelys G2338 echo the LXX rendering of Gen 1:27 in Matt 19:4, Mark 10:6, Rom 1:26-27, Gal 3:28. Five different biblical authors (Moses, Jesus through Matthew and Mark, Paul) repeat the same lexical binary across creation, law, marriage teaching, and ethics.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that God created humanity as male and female, and that this is a real created design, not a social arrangement humans assembled later. Genesis 1:27 says God created humankind in his own image, male and female he created them. Genesis 5:2 repeats it and adds that God named the species Man after both forms together. Genesis 2 tells how God made the woman from the man, and the man recognized her as bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh, and Genesis 2:24 says the two become one flesh in marriage. Jesus himself anchors marriage to this design in Matthew 19:4-6 and Mark 10:6, quoting both Genesis passages together: he who made them from the beginning made them male and female, therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and the two shall become one flesh. Paul argues in Romans 1:26-27 that same-sex relations are against nature, where nature is the male-female design God built into creation. The strongest complicating verse inside Scripture is Matthew 19:12, where Jesus names eunuchs from birth as a real category. Honest reading admits this. There are people born with anomalies of biological development, what today we call intersex conditions. The verdict handles this by saying the binary is the created norm and the anomalies are recognized as anomalies, not as evidence that the norm is unreal. A pediatric heart defect does not show that hearts were not designed; it shows that some are damaged in development. The harder question today is not the doctrine itself but the pastoral applications: how a church cares for a person who experiences gender dysphoria, whether to use

preferred pronouns in conversation, whether to perform same-sex weddings. Christians who agree the doctrine is true can disagree about those pastoral choices. But denying the doctrine itself, claiming God did not actually make humanity binary, is a different category. That denial cuts the cord with how Jesus reads Genesis in Matthew 19 and how Paul reasons about nature in Romans 1.

Denominational landscape

On the underlying doctrine that God created humanity male and female as a created binary, historic Christian agreement is uniform. The patristic witness affirms it (Augustine in City of God XIV.22 stresses the binary is physical and intentional, not symbolic). The Catholic Catechism paragraphs 369-373 teach that men and women possess inalienable dignity given immediately by God their Creator and are complementary as masculine and feminine, and the 2019 Vatican instruction Male and Female He Created Them addresses gender ideology directly. The Lutheran Augsburg Confession assumes the binary in its teaching on marriage and procreation. The Anglican Thirty-Nine Articles affirm marriage as instituted at creation. The Reformed Westminster Confession and the Methodist Articles agree. The Anabaptist Dordrecht Confession agrees. The Assemblies of God affirms the creational binary explicitly. The Orthodox Church in America affirms God creates human beings in his own image and likeness, male and female. Where current divergence exists, it is on pastoral application, not on the doctrine itself. The Church of England's Living in Love and Faith process since 2017 has not denied the creational binary but is debating whether and how to bless same-sex unions. The United Methodist Church's post-2024 reorganization came after the conservative Global Methodist contingent disaffiliated over pastoral applications. Public-record carriers of outright denial of the doctrine include progressive queer-theology programs that treat gender as fully constructed, and secular gender-identity ideology where it is imported into church teaching. Some liberal mainline Protestant streams have moved toward such denial. The historic boundary against denial of the creational binary itself remains uniform across the patristic, Catholic, Lutheran, Anglican, Reformed, Methodist, Anabaptist, Pentecostal, and Eastern Orthodox traditions.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Scope discipline matters. The DOCTRINE that God created humanity male and female as a created binary is what is on trial here, and it is canonically demonstrated five times by three biblical voices. Denial of the doctrine itself (claim that God did not create humanity binary, or that the binary is a social construct with no creational basis) places a teacher outside historic Christianity. Public-record carriers of such denial: progressive mainline Protestant streams that have moved to a fully constructed view of gender,

queer-theology programs, and secular gender-identity ideology imported into church teaching. This is the boundary the cult-marker flag is set to. Distinct from the doctrine are the pastoral-application questions that currently divide otherwise-confessing Christian denominations: (a) how to provide pastoral care to a trans-identifying person seeking Christ, (b) whether to use preferred pronouns as a courtesy, (c) whether to perform same-sex marriages. Christian traditions that confess the creational binary still divide on these pastoral questions (Church of England's Living in Love and Faith process since 2017, post-2024 United Methodist disaffiliation of the Global Methodist Church contingent, broad-Anglican complexity). Those pastoral disagreements are NOT cult-marker territory; they are in-house disagreements among traditions that all still confess the underlying doctrine. Matt 19:12 must be acknowledged honestly: Jesus names *eunouchoi ek koilias metros* (eunuchs from birth) as a category, recognizing congenital anomalies (today described as intersex conditions) without dissolving the binary as the created norm. Honest exegesis surfaces this without weaponizing it. The category Jesus names is not a third sex but a recognition of creational anomaly that the canonical binary as norm can accommodate pastorally. The Catholic CCC 369-373, the Vatican's 2019 Male and Female He Created Them, the Orthodox Synod, the Augsburg confession, the broader patristic consensus (Augustine City of God XIV.22), and Pentecostal statements all uniformly affirm the creational binary. Where current Anglican / Methodist / mainline divergence exists is on pastoral application, not on the underlying doctrine the question names.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked

Grammatico-historical reading of the canonical lexical pattern is sufficient and decisive on the underlying doctrine. The male-female creational binary is named at the creation account itself (Gen 1:27, Gen 2:18-24, Gen 5:2), reaffirmed by Jesus citing both Genesis passages in Matt 19:4-6 and Mark 10:6-9, and used by Paul as the lexical-ethical ground for Rom 1:26-27 (*para physin*) and the *arsenokoites* coinage in 1 Cor 6:9 and 1 Tim 1:10. *Analogia scripturae* is heavily invoked: five biblical voices repeat the same pair. No interpretive framework (covenantal, dispensational, new-covenant theology, progressive covenantalism) produces a different verdict; the binary doctrine sits underneath every framework. Progressive revelation is not in play because the creation account already names the binary at full strength; later revelation confirms rather than expands. Matt 19:12 is the honest complicating text: Jesus names *eunouchoi ek koilias metros* as a real category. This is handled by reading the binary as the created norm and the anomaly as a recognized creational deviation that does not dissolve the norm. The pastoral-application questions (transgender pastoral care, preferred pronouns, same-sex marriage performance) are where current denominational divisions exist but are not the doctrine the question puts on trial. Those applications are evaluated case by case and do not require a non-default hermeneutic to maintain the underlying creational binary.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Gen.1.27 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: parallelism, merism

Key term. אָרָב *bara* H1254 (created); תִּלְעַם *tselem* H6754 (image); זָכָר *zakar* H2145 (male); נֶעֱבָה *neqebah* H5347 (female)

Force. *vayyivra* Elohim *et-haadam* *betsalmo*, *betselem* Elohim *bara* *oto*, *zakar* *uneqebah* *bara* *otam*. Three parallel clauses naming the divine creative act. *Zakar* (masc sg noun, male of humans and animals) and *neqebah* (fem sg noun, female of humans and animals) are paired as the two divinely created forms of *haadam* (humanity). The verb *bara* is reserved in Genesis for divine creation; its threefold repetition in this verse alone signals weight.

Gen.5.2 · for · genre: narrative · figures: merism

Key term. זָכָר zakar H2145; נֶעֱבַח neqebah H5347; אָדָם bara H1254; אָרָק qara H7121 (called); אָדָם adam H120 (Man, humanity)

Force. zakar uneqebah beraam vayyivarekh otam vayyiqra et-shemam adam beyom hibbaream. God created them male and female, and he blessed them, and he called their name Adam (Man) in the day they were created. The binary is the content of the species-name. The divine naming act fixes the binary as definitional of humanity, not as one optional configuration among others.

Gen.2.18-24 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. אִישׁ ish H376 (man); אִשְׁשָׁה ishshah H802 (woman); עֲזָרָה ezer H5828 (helper); בָּשָׂר basar H1320 (flesh); אֶחָד echad H259 (one)

Force. v.18: lo tov heyot haadam levaddo, eeseh-lo ezer kenegdo (a helper corresponding to him). v.23: zot happaam etsem meatsamai uvasar mibesari, lezot yiqqare ishshah ki me-ish luqachah-zot (this one shall be called ishshah for from ish she was taken). v.24: vehayu lebasar echad (they shall become one flesh). The ish / ishshah etymological wordplay binds the pair into a single created design. Ezer kenegdo (helper corresponding to him) marks complementarity. Basar echad presupposes two distinct parties uniting.

Matt.19.4-6 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. κτίζω ktizo G2936 (created); ἄρσεν arsen G730 (male); θῆλυς thelys G2338 (female); κολλάω kollao G2853 (joined); σὰρξ sarx G4561 (flesh); μία mia G3391 (one)

Force. ouk anegnoute hoti ho ktisas ap arches arsen kai thely epoiesen autous, kai eipen heneka toutou kataleipsei anthropos ton patera kai ten metera kai kolletheetai te gynaikei autou, kai esontai hoi dyo eis sarka mian. Jesus quotes Gen 1:27 (LXX rendering arsen kai thely) and Gen 2:24 together. The binary is named as the creational ground (ap arches, from the beginning) for the union of marriage. Jesus' hermeneutic welds the binary to the marriage union.

Mark.10.6-9 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἀρχή arche G746 (beginning); κτίσις ktisis G2937 (creation); ἄρσεν arsen G730; θῆλυς thelys G2338

Force. apo de arches ktiseos arsen kai thely epoiesen autous. Mark's parallel to Matt 19. The phrase apo arches ktiseos (from the beginning of creation) locates the binary as a creational ordinance, not a cultural arrangement. Mark intensifies Matthew's ap arches with ktiseos.

Rom.1.26-27 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. θῆλυς thelys G2338 (female); ἄρσεν arsen G730 (male); φύσις physis G5449 (nature); παρὰ para G3844 (against); χρῆσις chresis G5540 (use)

Force. hai te gar thelyai auton meteliaxan ten physiken chresin eis ten para physin, homoios kai hoi arsenes aphentes ten physiken chresin tes thelyas. Paul names same-sex relations as exchange of the natural use for that against nature. Para physin (against nature) presupposes a physis, and that physis is the male-female ordering instantiated by thelyai and arsenes. Paul's lexical pairing here mirrors the LXX of Gen 1:27, locking the ethical argument to the creational binary.

1Cor.6.9-10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀρσενοκοίτης arsenokoites G733 (male-bedder); μαλακός malakos G3120 (soft, passive partner)

Force. Paul coins arsenokoites (G733) from the LXX of Lev 18:22 and Lev 20:13 (arsenos koiten), naming a sexual act between two males. The very vocabulary presupposes the male-female binary as the norm being violated. The compound noun is a lexical fingerprint pointing back to the creational ordering.

Matt.19.12 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. εὐνοῦχος eunouchos G2135 (eunuch); κοιλία koilia G2836 (womb); μήτηρ meter G3384 (mother)

Force. eisin eunouchoi hoitines ek koilias metros egennethesan houtos, kai eisin eunouchoi hoitines eunouchisthesan hypo ton anthronon, kai eisin eunouchoi hoitines eunouchisan heautous dia ten basileian ton ouranon. Jesus names three categories: congenital (eunuchs from birth, ek koilias metros), surgical (made by other people), and voluntary celibates (for the kingdom). The first category honestly acknowledges creational anomalies (intersex conditions in modern terms) without dissolving the binary as the created norm. Jesus says this immediately after teaching the binary in 19:4-6.

Gal.3.28 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ἄρσεν arsen G730; θήλυς thelys G2338; εἷς heis G1520 (one)

Force. ouk eni loudaios oude Hellen, ouk eni doulos oude eleutheros, ouk eni arsen kai thely, pantes gar hymeis heis este en Christo lesou. Paul names equal standing in Christ across the male-female pair (and across Jew-Gentile, slave-free). The verse names the binary as a real created distinction that does not divide gospel-access; it does NOT erase the categories themselves. The categories Jew, Greek, slave, free continued to exist; the verse teaches equal salvation-access across them.

Deut.22.5 · for · genre: law

Key term. יָלֵךְ keli H3627 (article, garment); גֶּוֶר gever H1397 (man); שִׁמְלַת simlah H8071 (clothing); אִשָּׁה ishshah H802 (woman); תְּעוּבָה toevah H8441 (abomination)

Force. lo-yiheyeh keli-gever al-ishshah velo yilbash gever simlat ishshah, ki toavat YHWH Eloheikha kol-oseh elleh. A man shall not wear what pertains to a woman, nor shall a woman put on a man's garment. The legal application presupposes the binary as fixed and visible in cultural marking. The presence of the law shows the binary is regarded as a real ordered distinction worth preserving culturally.

Lev.18.22 · for · genre: law

Key term. זָכָר zakar H2145; מִשְׁכָּב mishkav H4904 (lying with); אִשָּׁה ishshah H802; תְּעוּבָה toevah H8441

Force. veet-zakar lo tishkav mishkevei ishshah, toevah hi. You shall not lie with a male as one lies with a woman; it is an abomination. The verse explicitly contrasts zakar with ishshah and presupposes the binary as the ordered norm against which the prohibition is defined. Paul's coinage arsenokoites in 1 Cor 6:9 and 1 Tim 1:10 is built from the LXX of this verse.

Gen.6.19 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. זָכָר zakar H2145; נֶעֱבָה neqebah H5347; חַי chay H2416 (living)

Force. mikkol hachay mikkol-basar shenayim mikkol tavi el-hattevah ... zakar uneqebah yiheyu. The same male-female binary applied to all flesh entering the ark. The lexical pair zakar / neqebah is not restricted to humans but is named as the order of created life. This is the doctrinally important wider pattern: the binary is the structural ordering of biological life as created.

Matt.19.5 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. πατήρ pater G3962; μήτηρ meter G3384; γυνή gyne G1135 (wife); σὰρξ sarx G4561; μία mia G3391

Force. heneka toutou kataleipsei anthropos ton patera kai ten metera kai kolletheetai te gynaiki autou. Jesus' citation of Gen 2:24 names a binary parental pair (father and mother, pater and meter, pointing back to ish/ishshah) and the binary marital pair (man and woman, anthropos and gyne). Both pairs presuppose the creational binary as the structural ground of family.

Eph.5.31-32 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. ἀνὴρ aner G435 (husband, man); γυνή gyne G1135 (wife, woman); μυστήριον mysterion G3466 (mystery)

Force. Paul cites Gen 2:24 (anti toutou kataleipsei anthropos ton patera kai ten metera kai proskolletheetai pros ten gynaika autou, kai esontai hoi dyo eis sarka mian) and calls it a mysterion concerning Christ and the church. The Christ-church relation is figured through the binary marital union, locking the binary into the theology of redemption.

1Tim.1.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀρσενokoίτης arsenokoites G733

Force. Paul's vice-list places arsenokoitais alongside pornois (sexual immoral), andrapodistais (slave-traders), pseustais (liars). The compound is a lexical signal that the binary is the norm against which the named violation is defined. The presence of this compound in two Pauline lists (1 Cor 6:9 and 1 Tim 1:10) confirms it is settled vocabulary, not an isolated coinage.

Concordance lemmas traversed

H2145, H5347, H376, H802, H120, H1254, H1320, H259, H5828, H7121, H6754, H4904, H8441, H3627, H1397, H8071, H2416, G730, G2338, G2936, G2937, G746, G3844, G5449, G5540, G2853, G4561, G3391, G733, G3120, G2135, G2836, G3384, G3962, G1135, G435, G3466, G1520, G2064

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Augustine, City of God Book XIV chapter 22 (CCEL NPNF1 Vol 2) · affirms · verified

“God created two distinct sexes intentionally and blessed them with increase. The bishop of Hippo argues against reading male and female as abstract principles within one person; the binary is physical reality designed for procreation.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church, paragraphs 369-373 (Article: Man and Woman He Created Them) · affirms · verified

“Man and woman possess an inalienable dignity which comes to them immediately from God their Creator. Created for each other to form a communion of persons, equal as persons and complementary as masculine and feminine.”

catholic_magisterial · Vatican Congregation for Catholic Education, Male and Female He Created Them (2 February 2019), guidance on gender theory in education · affirms · unverified

“Vatican document addresses gender ideology in education and reaffirms male-female complementarity as a creational design, rejecting the claim that gender identity is fully self-determined.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530), Article XXIII Of the Marriage of Priests; bookofconcord.org · affirms · verified

“God created man for procreation, Genesis 1:28. The confession assumes the male-female binary as the creational basis for marriage and procreation, arguing that priestly celibacy violates divine design.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article XXV Of the Sacraments; Book of Common Prayer Solemnization of Matrimony preface · affirms · unverified

“Anglican liturgy and articles assume marriage is instituted by God in the time of man's innocence between one man and one woman. The Church of England's Living in Love and Faith process since 2017 debates pastoral applications but has not denied the creational binary.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith (1646), Chapter 24 paragraph 1 Of Marriage and Divorce · affirms · unverified

“Marriage is to be between one man and one woman. The confession grounds the institution in the creation order and treats the male-female pairing as definitive of the marital ordinance.”

methodist · United Methodist Book of Discipline, Social Principles, post-2024 reorganization; Global Methodist Church doctrine · affirms · unverified

“Both the post-2024 United Methodist Church and the disaffiliated Global Methodist Church continue to confess male-female as creational design; current denominational divergence is on pastoral application of same-sex marriage, not on the underlying binary.”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession of Faith (1632), Article XII Of Marriage · affirms · unverified

“The confession teaches marriage between one man and one woman, presupposing the creational binary as the basis of the marital union.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, position paper on transgenderism, transsexuality and gender identity; Statement of Fundamental Truths · affirms · unverified

“AG affirms that God created human beings male and female as distinct and complementary, and that gender identity should be received as a gift coherent with biological sex.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, Synodal Affirmations on Marriage, Family, Sexuality, and the Sanctity of Life · affirms · verified

“God creates human beings in His own image and likeness, male and female, declaring human life with all that He makes to be very good, and wills that men and women marry, becoming husbands and wives.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/1-27.htm>

“Gen 1:27: zakar H2145 (male, masc sg noun) and uneqebah H5347 (female, fem sg noun) paired in the final clause naming the created binary as the image-bearing form.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/2145.htm>

“Zakar H2145 occurs about 82 times in the OT as male of humans and animals, appearing in narrative, legal, genealogical, and liturgical contexts.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/5347.htm>

“Neqebah H5347 occurs 22 times in the OT (Gen 1:27, 5:2, 6:19, 7:3, 7:9, 7:16, Lev 3:1, 3:6, 4:28, 4:32, 5:6, 12:5, 12:7, 15:33, 27:4-7, Num 5:3, 31:15, Deut 4:16, Jer 31:22), always paired with zakar.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/19-4.htm>

“Matt 19:4: ho ktisas (G2936) ap arches arsen (G730) kai thely (G2338) epoiesen autous. Jesus quotes Gen 1:27 LXX as the foundation for marriage in 19:5-6.”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/19-12.htm>

“Matt 19:12: eunouchoi G2135 ek koilias metros, eunuchs from birth. Jesus names a real category of creational anomaly immediately after teaching the binary in 19:4-6.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/1-26.htm>

“Rom 1:26: hai thelyai (G2338) auton metelioxan ten physiken chresin (G5540) eis ten para physin (G3844 G5449). Para physin presupposes a physis that the binary instantiates.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/2-24.htm>

“Gen 2:24: vehayu lebasar (H1320) echad (H259). The one-flesh union presupposes the prior distinction between ish (H376) and ishshah (H802).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/genesis/5-2.htm>

“Gen 5:2: zakar uneqebah beraam ... vayyiqra et-shemam adam. God named the species Adam (humanity) referring to both forms together; the binary is the content of the species-name.”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P1B.HTM

“CCC 369-372: man and woman possess an inalienable dignity which comes to them immediately from God their Creator. They are created for each other, equal as persons and complementary as masculine and feminine.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/holy-synod/statements/holy-synod/synodal-affirmations-on-marriage-family-sexuality-and-the-sanctity-of-life>

“OCA Holy Synod: God creates human beings in His own image and likeness, male and female. God declares human life to be very good and wills that men and women marry.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/of-marriage-of-priests/>

“Augsburg Confession on marriage and creation: God created man for procreation, Genesis 1:28. The binary is assumed as the creational basis for the marital ordinance.”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/npnf102/npnf102.iv.XIV.22.html>

“Augustine, City of God XIV.22: God created two distinct sexes as physical reality designed for procreation; not abstract principles within one person.”

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